

A FREE GUIDE



The Seven Dracula Myths

And what the history actually says

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Seven Things You Know About Dracula



Dracula is one of the most famous names on earth, and almost everything the world believes about the man behind it is wrong. What follows are seven of the largest myths, set beside what the records actually say. If they unsettle you, there are five centuries more where these came from.

MYTH I



Bram Stoker based Dracula on Vlad the Impaler.

THE TRUTH. Stoker's surviving working notes barely mention Vlad at all. The vampire's working name, in the early drafts, was simply Count Wampyr. He took the name Dracula from a single footnote in a library book, and almost nothing else. The prince and the vampire are two different stories that brushed past each other once.

MYTH II



The name Dracula means son of the devil.

THE TRUTH. Vlad's father was inducted into the Order of the Dragon, and took the name Dracul, from the Latin for dragon. Dracula, or Drăculea, meant son of the Dragon. Only later did the Romanian word drift toward devil. The origin is a knightly order, not a demon.

MYTH III



Bran Castle was Dracula's castle.

THE TRUTH. Vlad never lived there. No contemporary document places him inside Bran. His real fortress was Poenari, a brutal climb of broken stone that draws a fraction of the crowds. Bran is a handsome Saxon customs fort, marketed on a fictional connection to a man who had nothing to do with it.

MYTH IV



He murdered a hundred thousand people.

THE TRUTH. The largest totals all come from his enemies, and they grow with every retelling, until one chronicler reaches nearly half the population of his own country. Rebuilt from what we know of medieval war, a careful reckoning lands closer to six to eight thousand across a thirty year reign. Brutal, but not uniquely so for his century.

MYTH V



The old horror stories are history.

THE TRUTH. The fifteenth-century pamphlets were Europe's first mass-market horror, printed to sell by the Saxon merchants Vlad had raided and impaled. When you test them as texts, less than half of the specific horrors can be corroborated from any independent source. The monster was commissioned, not discovered.

MYTH VI



He was the sword of Christendom against Islam.

THE TRUTH. By the Ottoman tax registers, the riverside communities Vlad struck in his most famous campaign were largely Balkan Christians serving the empire as auxiliaries. The clean story of a holy war against the Turk does not survive contact with the records.

MYTH VII



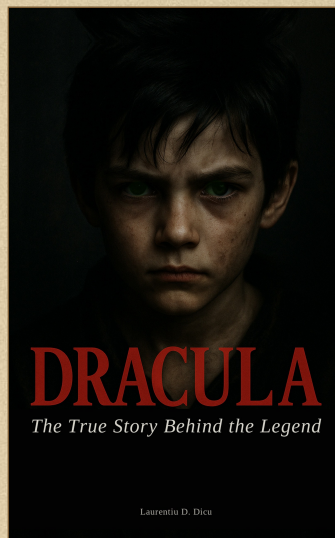
He drank blood.

THE TRUTH. Not a single contemporary source says so. The blood-drinking belongs entirely to the vampire, assembled in the nineteenth century out of Balkan folklore and Gothic fiction. The real prince, who died in the winter of 1476, never touched it.



The Real History, in Full

These seven are only the beginning. My book tells the true story of Vlad III of Wallachia, and the five centuries of myth built on top of him. Carefully researched, and written to read like a story.



Dracula: The True Story Behind the Legend

<https://www.amazon.com/dp/B0HJHKQK7T>